

Accessibility Information

Requesting Accessibility Accommodations

Graduates should request any accessibility accommodations for **themselves and their guests** when they register to attend the ceremonies through Tassel. Tassel registration for the Class of 2026 will open in late March of 2026.

Accessibility Aides

At the commencement and doctoral hooding sites there will be an identified table to collect pre-reserved devices and accessible materials, including assisted listening devices and other reserved accessibility aides.

Accessible Parking at UMass Boston

Accessible paid parking is available in a few locations on campus, including:

- Campus Center Garage (limited to vehicles with HP placard)
- Quad Lot (HP and general parking)
- West Garage (HP and general parking)
- Lot D (HP and general parking)
- Bayside Lot (HP and general parking)

A [Campus Map](#) shows the location of each parking lot. Free shuttles will run from the Bayside Lot and West Garage to the Campus Center. All of the UMass Boston's transportation shuttles are accessible and are equipped with a wheel-chair lift. The larger shuttles are outfitted with low floors and have the ability to "kneel" to allow accessible access. The accessibility lift can also be activated to assist with boarding and un-boarding of the shuttle without climbing or descending stairs.

A valid state issued HP license plate, hang tag or UMB Temporary Accessible Parking Permit is required to park in a designated accessible parking space.

Accessible Seating – Undergraduate and Graduate Ceremony

For **graduates**: Specific seating locations are designated within the ceremony area for each individual school/college. Graduating students requiring an accessible path of travel will be seated near the main stage in an area with hard flooring on the accessible path. Graduates will join their school/ college for the processional onto the lawn and to cross the stage area during the ceremony. Upon request a commencement volunteer will be assigned to assist graduates requiring mobility assistance.

For **guests**: A specific seating location with hard flooring on an accessible path of travel is designated on the commencement lawn. Guests who use wheelchairs and scooters may be accompanied by a companion. Commencement volunteers will be available to direct guests to the accessible seating area.

Accessible Seating - Doctoral Hooding Ceremony

For **students**: An appropriate accessible location will be reserved for each doctoral graduate who requires accessible seating or room for mobility devices.

For **guests**: ample seating locations are designated within the guest seating area for wheelchair guests.

Guest Drop off Locations

For those guests who require an accessible drop off location close to the ceremony site, there is an accessible drop off zone located next to the Campus Center. The accessible drop off zone can be accessed from University Drive South. Transportation staff and officers will be directing traffic on University Drive South and at the accessible drop off zone. Please be prepared to inform officers and staff that you are making an accessible drop off or pick up. Parking is not allowed at the drop off zone. Drivers will need to park in one of the designated campus lots and meet their party back at the ceremony site.

As we get closer to the ceremony, please consult the Commencement Day Campus Map to view the exact location of the Accessible Drop Off Zone.

Service Animals

Service dogs are welcome to accompany their disabled handler at the graduation ceremonies and doctoral hooding. Pets are not permitted at any of the ceremonies.

Temporary Restrooms

Accessible portable restrooms will be provided near the back of the campus center lawn on an accessible path of travel.

Wheelchair rentals

No mobility equipment will be provided by the University, so persons with mobility impairments are encouraged to arrange for rental of their own wheelchairs, walker, etc.

- Belmont Medical Supply- 85 Belmont Street, Belmont MA 617-484-3888; cost \$25/day
- Gary Drug Company – 59 Charles Street, Boston MA, 617-227-0023; cost \$20/ day
- Sullivan’s Medical Supply – 1 Corinth Street, Roslindale MA; 617-325-0013, cost \$25/day plus mandatory delivery and pick up charges of \$25 each way.

If you have questions or comments regarding this accommodations process or need additional assistance, please contact GradADA@umb.edu and events@umb.edu.

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